



NOW ACCEPTING APPLICATIONS FROM USC STUDENTS

Undergraduate Research Assistant: Collective Bargaining and AI

Fall 2026 | Remote | Applications received by September 18 receive priority

THE OPPORTUNITY

The USC Department of Political Science and International Relations is seeking an undergraduate research assistant for a project examining collective bargaining, unions, and the governance of artificial intelligence in the workplace. The project is building a large, cross-national dataset of collective bargaining agreements.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- Identify public repositories of collective bargaining agreements in new countries.
- Web scrape agreements and associated metadata.
- Download, organize, and document contracts from government, union, and employer websites.
- Clean and harmonize agreement dates, employers, unions, sectors, locations, and bargaining units.
- Convert PDF agreements into machine-readable text using text extraction and OCR tools.
- Check the completeness and accuracy of scraped and extracted data.
- Assist with translation workflows and basic text analysis.
- Maintain clear documentation and reproducible research files; participate in regular team meetings.
- Support a measurement pipeline that identifies provisions such as technology incorporation.

USC STUDENTS ONLY

Applicants must be currently enrolled USC undergraduate students. Please apply only if you meet the qualifications.

APPOINTMENT

Hours
Approximately 10-20 per week

Period
Fall 2026; ideal start by the end of September, with possible renewal

Pay
\$18.42 per hour, subject to final university approval

Arrangement
Remote

RESEARCH FOCUS

Collective bargaining
Workplace technology
Artificial intelligence
Worker data and monitoring
Training and job security



Qualifications & Application

ELIGIBILITY

Applicants must be currently enrolled undergraduate students at USC. We welcome students from data science, computer science, economics, public policy, or related fields.

STRONG CANDIDATES WILL HAVE

- Careful attention to detail and strong organizational skills.
- Some experience with Python.
- Experience with web scraping and NLP tools.
- An interest in labor, technology, artificial intelligence, or comparative political economy.
- The ability to work independently and communicate progress clearly.
- Knowledge of a language other than English is not required but is especially welcomed.

PROJECT & TEAM

The project is supported by OpenAI and Schmidt Sciences' AI at Work program. The research assistant will join an interdisciplinary team of faculty, postdoctoral researchers, and student researchers from several institutions, including the University of Zurich and OpenAI.

HOW TO APPLY

Email the following materials:

- A resume.
- A one-page statement describing your interest and relevant experience.
- Your availability during the semester.
- Optional: an example of relevant coursework, code, or a research project.

SEND TO

gonzalez.rostani@usc.edu

SUBJECT LINE

"CBA Research Assistant"

PRIORITY DEADLINE

September 18, 2026

Applications received by this date will receive priority consideration.

QUESTIONS?

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Assistant Professor

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